AI, Ethics and Climate Governance Fellowship 2026

About the Fellowship
Emerging Climate Frontiers (ECF) and the Young Africans Research Academy (YARA) are inviting applications for the inaugural **AI, Ethics and Climate Governance Fellowship**.

The fellowship is an eight-week online programme designed to build a cohort of emerging African researchers, practitioners, advocates and policy thinkers who can critically examine and contribute to the governance of artificial intelligence and other frontier climate technologies.

Artificial intelligence is increasingly being used across climate modelling, agriculture, energy systems, early-warning systems, carbon measurement and environmental decision-making. At the same time, questions of data governance, algorithmic bias, accountability, justice, transparency, consent and unequal global power are becoming increasingly important.

The fellowship will equip participants to understand these questions, examine existing governance systems, and develop African-grounded approaches to the governance of technologies shaping the continent's climate future.

Approximately **25 fellows** will be selected from across Africa.
Fellowship Dates

Onboarding: 20th October 2026
Programme: 21st October–15th December 2026
Application Deadline: 16th October 2026, 11:59 PM GMT

Format

The fellowship is fully online.

Fellows should expect approximately **five hours of engagement per week**, including a weekly live session, readings, discussions and collaborative work.

Sessions will be recorded and learning materials will be designed with different connectivity conditions in mind.

What Fellows Will Explore

Topics will include:

- Artificial intelligence and its applications in climate action
- AI ethics and climate justice
- Data governance, algorithmic bias and consent
- Power, technology and the Global South
- African and international AI governance frameworks
- Governance of emerging and frontier climate technologies
- Carbon dioxide removal and solar radiation modification
- Responsible innovation and technology policy
- Writing evidence-informed governance policy briefs

Fellowship Output

Fellows will work individually or collaboratively to produce a **1,500–2,000-word governance policy brief** grounded in a real policy or governance challenge within an African country, sector or discipline.

Selected outstanding briefs may be published by ECF and YARA.

Fellows who successfully complete the programme will receive a certificate and join the ECF–YARA fellowship alumni network.

Who Should Apply

We particularly welcome applications from early-career Africans including:

Junior researchers and graduate students; early-career policy professionals; civil-society and development practitioners; climate and environmental professionals; journalists and advocates; researchers and practitioners working in technology, computing, law, economics, public policy and the social sciences.

You do not need a technical background in artificial intelligence to apply.

Applications will be assessed on motivation, relevance of experience or study, analytical potential, interest in African technology and climate governance, contribution to the cohort, and ability to commit to the programme.

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